

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 332

By Yarbro

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the Hillsboro Burros boys' basketball team upon winning the 2025 TSSAA Division I, Class 4A state championship.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly should salute those student athletes who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as true champions of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such exemplary group of lads is the Burros boys' basketball team of Hillsboro High School, whose members have proven themselves to be the fiercest of competitors and truly worthy of admiration by winning the 2025 TSSAA Division I, Class 4A state championship, the first such state championship in school history and the first by a Metro Nashville large class school since 1981; and

WHEREAS, entering regional competition as District 11 champions, Hillsboro quickly cleared the decks by crushing Green Hill 69-38 in the quarterfinals, thumping Cane Ridge 67-41 in their semifinal match-up, and cruising past Beech 51-38 in the final to win the Region 6 championship; and

WHEREAS, the Burros then crushed Centennial 51-23 in the sectional round to punch their ticket for the Big Dance; and

WHEREAS, poised for ultimate victory in the Class 4A state tournament at MTSU's Murphy Center, Hillsboro bested Maryville 53-47 in the quarterfinals and defeated Bradley Central 63-48 in the semifinal round to advance to the final; and

WHEREAS, appearing in their first state title game since 1956, the Burros prevailed over Oak Ridge by a score of 57-42 to claim the Gold Ball trophy that signifies a state champion and finish the 2024-2025 campaign with an outstanding 34-5 record; and

WHEREAS, the following young men proudly displayed the resilience and determination of Burros: Nortez Foxx, Tyren Fisher, Andrew Hull, Jabari Davis, Lonny Holland, Austan Harris, Xavier Washington, Kemonta Bassham, William Satterfield, Anthony Cooper, Rory Cawthon III, and title game standouts, Cortez Graham-Howard (20 points and five rebounds), Jalen Heard (11 points), and Max Burtner (12 points); and

WHEREAS, Hillsboro's superb performance would not have been possible without the expert guidance of Head Coach Rodney Thweatt and his assistant coaches, John Boucher, Mark Brown, Carlos Holder, Cameron Jordan, Joshua Shipman, and the unfailing support of the players' families, their fans, and their community; and

WHEREAS, the members of the Hillsboro boys' basketball team epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved a premier level of success in competition while exhibiting the highest degree of character in all aspects of life; and

WHEREAS, the perseverance, determination, work ethic, and talent of this group of young men not only made possible a championship but also surely bode well for their future success; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the Hillsboro Burros for their outstanding season on the hardwood; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the Hillsboro Burros boys' basketball team upon winning the 2025 TSSAA Division I, Class 4A state championship, the first in school history, and extend to them our best wishes for every continued success in all their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.